Step 1: Assess Current Status



Coordinate departures to the extent possible

Communicate with the departing team member to determine key processes and activities they perform. Ask them to conduct a "legacy" discussion with the team to share insights into their current work, career accomplishments, and tips for success. Check with the team member to see where they store their work documents and make sure they are shared with the team.

As time allows, adapt role-based tools from the **knowledge continuity guide** to support the transition. Please see best practices for offboarding from the NASA OCIO **here** and a **Microsoft 365 Offboarding Checklist** that can be used to make sure documents and crucial information are stored effectively.

Questions to consider:

- What will break if the departing team member is not there?
- What unique knowledge does the departing team member have?

Assess the gaps

Within a few weeks of a team member's departure, work with the remaining team members to identify gaps in expertise that may occur as a result of the change. Keep in mind that this may include recognizing years of experience, relationships and points of contact, and policy and process knowledge.

If multiple changes are occurring at once, a **knowledge audit or knowledge inventory** may help to surface the highest priority gaps.



Questions to consider:

- What specialty areas were affected by recent departures?
- What expertise is available among the team and what knowledge do we have in place that can sustain any gaps?